EDCJ – Elite Dangerous Commander's Journey

User manual · Version 0.9.7.6 · English

Quick start – up and running in two steps

You do **not need to set or enter anything**. All start parameters are optional and have sensible defaults:

1. **Linux:** type `python3 edcj.py` in the program folder. **Windows:** install Python 3 (tick “Add python.exe to PATH”) and double-click `EDCJ-Start.bat`.
2. The browser opens by itself. Done.

What	Automatic
Journal folder	Found automatically (Steam/Proton, Flatpak, Lutris, Wine, Windows “Saved Games”). Only for an unusual path: `-d "path"`.
Port	8800 (only on a conflict: `--port`).
Your data	Stored automatically in the `data/` folder next to the program.
Tablet / home network	Off by default. If you want it, switch it on in Settings (no parameter needed) and you get your own random code.
Language, theme, tabs	Chosen in Settings and saved.

> **About history:** On the first start EDCJ writes only the **last session** into the Captain's Log (text file). Career, play style, records, factions, bodies and scans, however, are read from **all** journals found. Markets and shipyards are only known for stations that appear in your journals or market files. Want more old sessions in the log? Start once, on the very first start, with `--backfill 50` – this only affects the log.

The start parameters in chapter 2 are only for special cases – you do not need to read them to use EDCJ.

1. What is EDCJ?

EDCJ reads the Elite Dangerous journal files and presents them as a web interface in your browser (default theme: Star Trek LCARS). It runs only on your own computer (Python 3, no extra packages).

- EDCJ **sends no data to the internet**, not to Inara or any other service, and does not use the Frontier CAPI.
- It evaluates only what is in **your own journals**. Nothing is invented or guessed; values the journal does not contain (e.g. shield strength) are not shown.
- EDCJ only knows markets, modules and shipyards of stations **you have visited yourself**.

2. Start and installation

System	Procedure
Linux	`python3 edcj.py` in the program folder. The journal folder is found automatically (Steam/Proton, Flatpak, Lutris, Wine).
Windows 10/11	Install Python 3 (tick “Add python.exe to PATH”), unzip, double-click `EDCJ-Start.bat`. Details: `INSTALLATION-WINDOWS.txt`.
Update	Unzip the new ZIP over the old folder (the `data/` folder is kept), restart EDCJ, press **Ctrl+F5** in the browser. The header must show the new version number. After some updates EDCJ rebuilds its database once from the journals on first start – this can take a moment.

Important start parameters

`-d FOLDER`	Specify the journal folder if it is not found
`--port 8800`	Port of the interface (default 8800)
`--lan`	Share on the home network (tablet), access only with an access code
`--app`	Open as app window (Chromium-based browsers)
`--no-browser`	Do not open the browser automatically
`--backfill N`	On the very first start, additionally write N older journals into the Captain's Log (affects only the log, not the evaluations)
`--log PATH`	Change the location of the Captain's Log (and thus the data)

To quit: Settings → Offline → “Shut down systems” (the Captain's Log is fully caught up first).

3. The interface

- **Header:** title, version, stardate (game time, UTC, year + 1286) and the fullscreen button.
- **Left bar:** the main groups (Cockpit, Navigation, Market, Ship, Career, Service record, Finances, Log, Settings).
- **Pills at the top:** the sub-tabs of the selected group. EDCJ remembers the last sub-tab per group.
- **Period / range:** many views have selection fields (e.g. 1 week to all time, 20/50/100 Ly or unlimited). Changes apply immediately.
- **Tables:** click a column header to sort. Large tables shorten the display and point to filters or a smaller period.
- **Clicking a system name** copies it to the clipboard; paste it into the in-game galaxy map with Ctrl+V. On a tablet, “Course set” is shown instead (the name goes to the PC's clipboard).
- **Several windows** (second monitor, tablet) can run at the same time and show the same data.
- **Adjustable:** theme (Star Trek, Elite Dangerous, Elite 1984, Monochrome), language (German/English) and which tabs are visible (Settings).

4. What is where?

Cockpit

Tab	Content
Live	Situation (station/planet/ring, platforms, market age, open missions to here, note), cockpit status (ship, system, target, balance, legal status, flags), fuel & power (tank, consumption, jumps until empty, jump range), cargo & best selling places, planned route, pace (net/gross per hour, current pace), credits of the session.
Missions	Running game missions with deadline, target, faction and distance; sorted by deadline, showing which missions lie on your route.
Maintenance	Pre-flight maintenance: fuel (also against the planned route), hull, modules, ammunition and rebuy against your balance, each as a traffic light (ok/warning/critical).

Navigation

Tab	Content
System	Current system: factions, rings & hotspots, stations & settlements, bodies in the system.
Diplomacy	Factions and influence: your interventions per system and faction, influence measurements, progress history.
Faction history	Faction values over time.
Planets & rings	Scanned bodies with properties, landability, biosignals.
Hotspots	Ring hotspots from your detailed scans (DSS), filterable by mineral and radius; unwanted entries can be hidden and restored.
Bio atlas	Analysed biology samples: species and locations.
Travel map	Top view (X/Z) and side view (X/Y) of the systems you visited. Mouse wheel = zoom, drag = pan; two-finger zoom on a tablet.

Market

Tab	Content
Local market	Last saved market of the current station with the difference to other known prices.
Commodity finder	Search prices: where was which price last.
Best trades	Best trade routes from the saved data, with filters for range, distance, landing pad size and price age.
Round trips	Two stations between which you can trade at a profit in both directions.
Analysis	Station analysis: date, amount, price; markets older than 7 days or missing.
Trade book	Trade diary per commodity: bought, sold, profit, sales compared with your saved market states (“given away”).

Ship

Buy equipment	Modules and ships offered at visited stations. If data is missing, open outfitting or the shipyard there once.
My fleet	Stored ships, loadouts, ship comparison (columns side by side: jump range, cargo, tank, core modules, shield, weapons, value, rebuy).
Fleet Carrier	State per the last carrier management in the game (fuel, finances, capacity). Not live.

Career

Career path	Ranks & reputation, exploration, discoveries (first discoveries, value estimate), landings, records, Powerplay, lifetime statistics, engineers, materials, blueprints (which ingredients you are missing for further crafts).
Combat	Kills, bounties, bonds, opponents, deaths and costs.
Mining	Mining, prospectors, drone costs, rings by yield, earnings per mining hour.
Play style	Pie chart of activities per week, weekly trend, heatmap weekday × time of day, records & streaks.

Service record (Journey)

Personnel file	Service rank, duty points, awards.
Journey missions	Daily, weekly, monthly and random missions plus the weekly chapter with three sub-goals. Target values are based on what you have achieved yourself in recent weeks. Random missions can be re-rolled or abandoned (max. 5 at once). Archive of completed jobs.
Milestones	Only count what you achieved in Journey missions.

Duty points: day 10, week 40, month 150, random 5–25, weekly chapter 60.

Finances

Pace	Credits per hour, balance, income and expenses by category.
Balance sheet	Income, trade profit, trade book, missions, assets, time profile, report (week and month comparison).

Log

Captain's Log	Automatically kept log (Markdown file) of all important events.
Search	Full-text search in the log; several words must all appear.
Notes	Your own notes on stations and systems, with tags and filter.
Gaps	Visited stations without a market record, systems with an incomplete scan, systems without coordinates.
Gallery	Screenshots (F10 in the game) with location, time, note, tags and favourites.
Flight recorder	Replay of past sessions with a speed selection.

All data	Lists of all saved records, e.g. all scanned bodies, all credit transactions, all events.

Settings

Settings	CSV export (Excel/LibreOffice, semicolon, decimal comma), data backup (save / restore), tablet & home network, fullscreen, show tabs, sound, language, appearance.
Offline	“Shut down systems” quits the program.

5. Tablet and second screen

1. In Settings under “Tablet & home network”, switch sharing on (or start with `--lan`) and restart EDCJ.
2. The address (e.g. `http://192.168.0.180:8800/`) and the access code are shown in Settings and in the start window.
3. Open the address in the tablet's browser and enter the code once. The PC itself needs no code.
4. Backup, restore and shutdown only work on the PC. Five wrong codes lock access for one minute.
5. Fullscreen: fullscreen button in the header or Settings; optionally automatic on the first tap. Swipe from the top to exit.

> **Tablet cannot reach the PC?** Usually the firewall is blocking it. Windows: allow “Private networks” on first start. Linux with ufw: `sudo ufw allow from 192.168.0.0/24 to any port 8800 proto tcp` (adjust the network). The access code only protects within the home network – EDCJ does not belong on the open internet.

6. Data, backup and privacy

- Your data lives in the `data/` folder next to `edcj.py`: `market.db` (everything collected), `captains_log.md` with helper files, screenshot copies. Without this folder EDCJ uses `~/.local/share/ed-lcars/` (Linux) or `%APPDATA%\EDCJ` (Windows).
- **Backup:** Settings → “Save backup” (ZIP with database, log and settings). On restore, the current state is backed up automatically first.
- The game's journals are only read, never modified.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
“Journal folder not found”	Start with `-d "path"` or set the environment variable `ED_JOURNAL_DIR` (Windows usually: `C:\Users\NAME\Saved Games\Frontier Developments\Elite Dangerous`).
Port in use / already running	EDCJ may already be running in another window, or choose another port with `--port`.
Interface shows an old version	Ctrl+F5 in the browser.

No data / “Journal inactive”	The game must have written a journal once; then the last session is shown.
No market for a station	Open the market once at the station – the game then writes `Market.json` and EDCJ picks it up automatically.
Clicking a system copies nothing	Linux: install `wl-clipboard` (Wayland) or `xclip` / `xsel` (X11).

8. Short glossary

Ly / Ls	Light years (between systems) / light seconds (within a system)
Cr	Credits
FSS / DSS	Full spectrum system scanner / detailed surface scanner (provides ring hotspots)
Rebuy	Cost of buying back your ship after a loss
DP	Duty points (Journey missions)
Journal	The log files Elite Dangerous writes while you play